

Herbs That Regulate the Blood

- Invigorate blood circulation, eliminate blood stasis, open blood vessels, disperse blood stagnation, and break blood stasis.
- Acrid, bitter and warm
- Blood stagnation: pain, numbness, masses, bruises, bleeding with blood clots, purpura and purple tongue.
- Differential diagnosis and treat blood stagnation accordingly.
- Caution: heavy menses, pregnancy.

Name	Similarities	Differences
Chuan Xiong (<i>Rhizoma Ligustici</i> <i>Chuanxiong</i>)	Invigorate the blood and move the qi	Moves qi within the blood Dispels wind and relieves pain
Yan Hu Suo (<i>Rhizoma Corydalis</i>)		Strongly moves qi and blood circulation, effectively relieves pain throughout the entire body
Yu Jin (<i>Radix Curcumae</i>)		Soothes the Liver, regulates the Gallbladder, reduces jaundice, clears heart and cools blood
Jiang Huang (<i>Rhizoma Curcumae</i> <i>Longae</i>)		Breaks up blood stasis, opens up channels and relieves pain
Ru Xiang (<i>Gummi Olibanum</i>)	Invigorate blood and relieve pain	Reduces swelling and promotes generation of flesh. Treats traumatic injuries with qi stagnation
Mo Yao (Myrrh)		Reduces swelling and promotes generation of flesh. Treats traumatic injuries with blood stagnation
Wu Ling Zhi (<i>Excrementum Troglodyti</i> <i>seu Pteromi</i>)		Eliminates blood stasis, relieves pain due to blood stasis, treats obstetric and gynecologic disorders
Hu Zhang (<i>Rhizoma Polygoni</i> <i>Cuspidati</i>)		Eliminates blood stasis, clears heat and toxins, dispels damp-heat
Dan Shen (<i>Radix Salviae Miltiorrhizae</i>)	Invigorate blood, eliminate blood stasis	Cools blood, reduces swelling, nourishes blood and calms the shen. Treats cardiovascular disorders,
Hong Hua (<i>Flos Carthami</i>)		Regulates menses. Treats gynecological disorders, masses or accumulations, joint pain etc.
Tao Ren (<i>Semen Persicae</i>)		Moistens intestines. Treats gynecological disorders, sports injuries, intestinal abscesses or constipation

Yi Mu Cao (Herba Leonuri)		Regulates menses, promotes diuresis, treats gynecological disorders
Ze Lan (Herba Lycopi)		Promotes diuresis
Chuan Niu Xi (Radix Cyathulae)		Invigorates blood, removes blood and sedates heat
Huai Niu Xi (Radix Achyranthis Bidentatae)		Tonifies Liver and Kidney
Wang Bu Liu Xing (Semen Vaccariae)	Invigorate blood, open channels and collaterals	Promotes lactation
Ji Xue Teng (Caulis Spatholobi)		Activates blood circulation and tonifies blood, treats <i>bi zheng</i> (painful obstruction syndrome)
San Leng (Rhizoma Sparganii)	Break up blood stasis, eliminate blood stasis	Breaks blood stagnation better
E Zhu (Rhizoma Curcumae)		Breaks qi stagnation better

Chuān Xiōng 川 芎

- Rhizoma Ligustici Chuanxiong
- English: Sichuan lovage rhizome
- Properties: acrid, warm
- Channels: Liver, Gallbladder, Heart

Actions and Indications

Actions: Invigorates the blood and promotes the movement of qi

Indications: This is one of the best herbs to treat GYN disorders: dysmenorrhea, amenorrhea, difficult labor or postpartum abdominal pain caused by blood stagnation. Moves qi within the blood

- Common combination: Dang Gui + Chuan Xiong
- Irregular menses: Chuan Xiong, Dang Gui, Chi Shao, Xiang Fu
- Difficult labor: Chuan Xiong, Dang Gui, Niu Xi, Gui Ban
- Liver qi constraint leading to blood stagnation: Dang Gui, Chuan Xiong, Chai Hu, Xiang Fu

Actions: Expels wind and alleviates pain

Indications: a leading herb for any externally-contracted wind disorder characterized by headache, dizziness or painful obstruction

Actions: Chuan Xiong dispels wind and relieves pain

Indications: Essential herb to relieve all kinds of headaches and pain. “tou tong yao yao”

- Headache caused by wind-cold: Bai Zhi, Fang Feng, Xi Xin
- Headache from wind-heat: Ju Hua, Shi Gao, Mian Jing Zi
- Headache from blood stasis: Hong Hua, Dan Shen, Chi Shao
- Headache from blood deficiency: Dang Gui, Bai Shao, Shu Di Huang

- Bi Zheng (painful obstruction syndrome): Qiang Huo, Du Huo, Hai Feng Teng

Note: Chuan Xiong has been used to treat coronary heart disease and cerebrovascular disorders in recent years.

Main Actions:

- Invigorates the blood and promotes the movement of qi
- Expels wind and alleviates pain

Dosage: 3 to 10 grams in herbal decoction, 1.0 to 1.5 grams as powder.

Cautions:

Contraindicated in cases of yin-deficient heat.

Use with caution in cases of heavy menstrual bleeding or any bleeding disorder.

Review questions:

- Properties of Chuan Xiong
- Actions and indications of Chuan Xiong (moves qi within the blood)
- Headache “Yao Yao”
- List various herbs used for headaches and the type of headache they’re used for.
- Cautions.

Yán Hú Suǒ 延胡索

- Rhizoma Corydalis Yanhusuo
- Alternate names: Xuan Hu Suo, Yuan Hu Suo
- English: Corydalis
- Properties: acrid, bitter, warm
- Channels: Heart, Liver, Spleen

Actions and Indications

Actions: Invigorates the blood, promotes movement of qi and alleviates pain:

Indications: for almost any kind of pain due to blood stasis.

Yan Hu Suo is one of the most commonly used and effective herbs to relieve pain. It has an excellent ability to activate qi in the qi level and invigorate blood in the blood level. It is used to treat pain from a variety of causes in all parts of the body.

- Chest pain: Gua Lou, Xie Bai, Yu Jin, Wu Yao
- Epigastric pain: Chuan Lian Zi
- Gynecological pain: Dang Gui, Chuan Xiong, Xiang Fu
- Pain in the extremities: Dang Gui, Gui Zhi, Chi Shao,
- Trauma injury: Dang Gui, Chuan Xiong, Ru Xiang, Mo Yao

Main Actions:

- Invigorates blood
- Promotes movement of qi
- Alleviates pain

Dosage: 5 to 10 grams in decoction, with a maximum dosage of 20 grams. Use 1 to 1.5 grams of Yan Hu Suo powder, served with warm water. Frying this herb with vinegar enhances its analgesic function.

Review Questions:

- Actions and indications of Yan Hu Suo
- What herb invigorates blood and moves qi for treating various pain?
- How should this herb be prepared to enhance its analgesic function?

Yù Jīn 郁金 “constrained metal”

- Tuber *Curcumae*
- English: curcuma, aromatic turmeric tuber
- Properties: acrid, bitter, cold
- Channels: Heart, Liver, Gallbladder

Actions and Indications

Actions: Invigorates the blood, smooths the Liver and alleviates pain, chest and abdominal, hypochondriac pain, irregular menses, masses

Indications: Yu Jin is most effective for treating pain due to qi and blood stagnation. It smooths the liver and moves qi to release constraint, invigorates blood and eliminates blood stasis to relieve pain.

- Chest, abdominal or hypochondriac pain: Dan Shen, Chai Hu, Xiang Fu, Zhi Ke
- Menstrual cramps and abdominal pain due to liver qi constraint with heat: Chai Hu, Xiang Fu, Dang Gui, Bai Shao
- Masses in the hypochondrial region: Dan Shen, Bie Jia, Ze Lan, Qing Pi

Actions: Clears the Heart, cools the blood, moves qi and resolves constraint:

Indications: for dampness and phlegm obstructing the Heart orifices causing disorientation, epilepsy, seizures, mania and other shen disturbances: Shi Cang Pi, Yu Jin

Actions: Clears heat and cools the blood

Indications: for various bleeding disorders with blood stagnation caused by heat in the blood: nose bleeds, vomiting blood, blood in urine, heavy menstrual bleeding Sheng Di Huang, Mi Dan Pi, Zhi Zi, Niu Xi

Actions: Benefits the Gallbladder and reduces jaundice:

Indications: for gallbladder disorders, gallstones and jaundice.

It enhances the function of benefiting the GB and reducing jaundice.

Yin Chen Hai, Jin Qian Cao, Zhi Zi

Main Actions:

- Invigorates blood and alleviates pain

- Smooths the Liver and releases constraint
- Clears the heart and cools the blood
- Benefits the gallbladder and reduces jaundice

Dosage: 6-12 grams in decoction.

Cautions:

Yu Jin counteracts Ding Xiang.

Used with caution during pregnancy.

Review Questions

- Properties, actions and indications of Yu Jing
- Herb for treating liver qi stagnation with blood stasis.
- Herbs for treating Heart shen disturbance from dampness phlegm obstructing heart orifice.
- Herbs for clearing heat and cool the blood.
- Herbs for reduce jaundice
- Compare Yan Hu Suo (qi and blood Yu) and Yu Jin (liver qi Yu)

Jiāng Huáng 姜黄
“ginger yellow”

- Rhizoma Curcumae Longae
- English: turmeric
- Properties: acrid, bitter, warm
- Channels: Liver, Spleen

Actions and Indications

Actions: Breaks blood stasis, moves qi, invigorates the blood, unblocks menstruation and alleviates pain:

Indications: for chest or abdominal pain, amenorrhea or dysmenorrhea due to blood stasis: Hong Hua, Bai Shao, Yan Hu Sui

Actions: Opens channels and collaterals to alleviate pain (acrid, warm):

Indications: for Bi Zheng - wind-damp painful obstruction with blood stasis, especially in the upper limbs: Qiang Huo, Shang Zhi, Wei Ling Xian

Main Actions:

- Invigorates the blood and breaks blood stasis
- Moves qi, opens channels and relieves pain

Dosage: 5-10 grams

Review questions

- Properties, actions and indications of Jiang Huang
- What herb breaks blood stasis and moves qi?

- Review the herbs treating Bi syndrome and how does Jing Huang treating Bi Syndrome (external & internal)?

Rǔ Xiāng 乳香 “fragrant breast” “fragrant milk”

- Gummi Olibanum
- English: frankincense, mastic, olibanum
- Properties: acrid, bitter, warm
- Channels: Heart, Liver, Spleen

Actions and Indications

Actions: Invigorates the blood and relieves pain.

Indications: Ru Xiang has an excellent effect in relieving aches and pains caused by the stagnation of qi and blood. It treats various types of pain due to stagnation.

- Amenorrhea and dysmenorrhea: Dang Gui, Chuan Xiong, Xiang Fu
- Stomach and epigastric pain due to qi and blood stagnation: Chuan Lian Zi, Yuan Hu Suo
- Bi Zheng (painful obstruction syndrome): Qiang Huo, Qin Jiao
- Traumatic injuries with severe pain and bruises: Mo Yao, Hong Hua, Xue Jie, Bing Pian

Actions: Reduces swelling and promotes the generation of flesh.

Indications: applied topically as an ointment or powder. It has an excellent ability to reduce swelling, promote tissue growth, alleviate pain, and promote healing in skin lesions and ulcers.

- Carbuncles or skin infection, which is still hard and painful due to heat toxin.
 - Ru Xiang, Mo Yao,
 - Xiong Huang, She Xiang (xing xiao wan)
- Intestine abscess
 - Hong Teng, Zi Hua Di Ding
 - Liang Qiao, Jin Yin Hua

Main Actions:

- Invigorates the blood and relieves pain
- Reduces swelling and promotes generation of flesh

Dosage: 3 to 10 grams in decoction. Unprocessed Ru Xiang has a pungent smell and is often irritating to the stomach, causing nausea and vomiting.

Cautions:

Patients with a sensitive stomach should take Ru Xiang with caution. Its bitter taste may cause nausea and vomiting.

Ru Xiang is contraindicated during pregnancy and for individuals who do not have blood stagnation.

Mò Yào 没药

- Myrrha

- English: myrrh
- Properties: bitter, neutral
- Channels: Heart, Liver, Spleen

Actions and Indications

Actions: Invigorates the blood and dispels blood stasis, reduces swelling and alleviates pain:

Indications: Mo Yao and Ru Xiang have very similar functions. They are commonly used together for their synergistic strength, especially in treating pain due to blood stagnation. If used together, use less of each herb.

Actions: Reduces swelling and promotes the generation of flesh

Indications: applied topically as an ointment or powder. It can reduce swelling, promote tissue growth (generate flesh), alleviate pain, and accelerate healing in skin lesions and ulcers. It is particularly effective when combined with Ru Xiang in treating the above conditions.

Mo Yao: stronger in dispersing blood stagnation and eliminating blood stasis; more commonly used to treat epigastric pain from qi and blood stasis.

Ru Xiang: stronger in activating blood circulation and relaxing the tendons; more commonly used to treat musculoskeletal pain and bi zheng due to wind and dampness.

These two herbs often combine together to reduce swelling and promote generation of flesh.

Main Actions:

- Invigorates the blood and relieves pain
- Reduces swelling and promotes generation of flesh

Dosage: 3 to 10 grams in decoction.

Mo Yao is often irritating to the stomach, causing nausea and vomiting. Use less dosage if using these two herbs together.

Rǔ Xiāng 乳香 Mò Yào 没药

Review questions

- The common actions and clinical indications
- What are the differences between these two herbs?
- Common herbs that can be used topically for treating trauma injury
- Herbs that promote generation of flesh.
- Cautions when taking them together.

Dān Shēn 丹参

“red ginseng “

- Radix Salviae Miltiorrhizae
- English: salvia root
- Properties: bitter, slightly cold
- Channels: Heart, Liver, Pericardium

Actions and Indications

Actions: Invigorates the blood and dispels blood stasis.

Indications: for blood stasis disorders in the lower abdomen, such as dysmenorrhea, amenorrhea, palpable masses, and various types of pain due to blood stasis

- Dan Shen regulates blood and addresses various disorders caused by blood stagnation, including gynecological or cardiovascular disorders and the formation of blood stagnation nodules.
- Dan Shen has been used to treat many clinical conditions associated with blood stagnation, such as coronary heart disease and enlarged liver or spleen.
- Gynecological: Hong Hua, Tao Ren, Yi Mu Cao
- Chest pain, epigastric and abdominal pain: Gua Lou, Tan Xiang, Mu Xiang, Sha Ren
- Palpable masses and accumulations: San Leng, E Zhu, Bie Jia, Ze Lan
- Traumatic injury: Dang Gui, Hong Hua, Chuan Xiong

Actions: Cools the blood, eliminates blood stasis, reduces swelling of sores and abscesses

Indications: skin sores, initial stage of breast abscess: Jin Yin Hua, Lian Qiao, Ru Xiang, Dan Shen

Actions: Clears heat from the heart, nourishes blood and calms the shen (spirit)

Indications: especially useful for restlessness, irritability, palpitations, insomnia or heat entering the ying level.

Main Actions

- Invigorates blood and eliminates blood stasis
- Cools blood and reduces swelling
- Nourishes blood and calms shen.

Dosage: 5 – 15 grams in decoction, up to 30 grams. Liquid-frying Dan Shen with wine strengthens its function to invigorate blood.

Cautions:

Dan Shen is incompatible with Li Lu.

Patients with heavy menstrual bleeding, who are coughing blood or have blood in the urine should use Dan Shen with caution.

Review questions

- Properties, actions, and indications of Dan Shen
- What herb cools, invigorates, and nourishes blood?
- What herbs invigorate and cool blood?
- Common herbs for treating coronary heart disease.

Táo Rén 桃仁

“persica seed” “peach pit”

- Semen Persicae
- English: peach seed, persica

- Properties: bitter, sweet, neutral
- Channels: Heart, Large Intestine, Liver, Lung

Actions and Indications

Actions: Invigorates blood and removes blood stasis.

Indications: an important herb for resolving many problems associated with blood stasis, including menstrual disorders, abdominal pain, traumatic injury, Lung and Intestinal abscesses or abdominal masses.

Tao Ren is useful for a broad range of clinical disorders due to blood stagnation.

- Menstrual pain, amenorrhea or irregular menses: Hong Hua, Dang Gui, Chuan Xiong, Chi Shao
- Post-partum abdominal pain with profuse uterine bleeding: Tao Ren, Pao Jiang, Dang Gui, Chuan Xiong
- Traumatic injuries: Hong Hua, Jiu Da Huang, Chuan Shan Jia

In early stages of lung or intestinal abscess, heat-clearing and toxicity-releasing herbs are often combined with Tao Ren to eliminate stasis.

- Lung abscess: Yu Xing Cao, Lu Gen, Dong Gua Zi, Yi Yi Ren
- Intestine abscess: Da Huang, Mu Dan Pi, Dong Gua Zi, Hong Teng, Bai Jiang Cao

Actions: Moistens the Intestines and unblocks the bowels.

Indications: for constipation due to dry Intestines: Huo Ma Ren, Gua Lou Ren

Main Actions:

- Invigorates blood and removes blood stasis
- Moistens the intestines and unblocks the bowels

Dosage: 6 -10 grams in decoction. Tao Ren seeds should be crushed prior to decoction.

Cautions:

Tao Ren is contraindicated during pregnancy due to its emmenagogue effects (tong jing).

Review questions

- Actions and indications of Tao Ren
- What herbs are commonly used to treat menstrual disorders?
- What herbs are used for lung abscess?
- What herbs are used for intestinal abscess?
- What herbs moisten the intestine and unblock bowel movements?
- How is Tao Ren prepared when making a decoction?

Hóng Huā 红花 “red flower”

- Flos Carthami Tinctorii
- English: safflower, carthamus
- Properties: acrid, warm
- Channels: Heart, Liver

Actions and Indications

Actions: Invigorates the blood and unblocks menstruation, opens channels and regulates menses:

Indications: for blood stasis patterns with amenorrhea, abdominal pain, post-partum dizziness and abdominal masses

- Hong Hua acts extremely well to invigorate blood and eliminate blood stasis. It has a broad range of clinical applications.
- Hong Hua is one of the most commonly-used herbs for obstetric and gynecologic conditions. It is often combined with Tao Ren. Tao Ren, Dang Gui, Chuan Xiong, Chi Shao

Actions: Invigorates blood, dispels blood stasis and alleviates pain:

Indications: for blood stasis wounds and pain, nonsuppurative sores, carbuncles and dark purplish erythema

Main Actions:

Invigorates blood, eliminates blood stasis, and regulates menses.

Dosage: 3-10 grams in decoction.

Cautions:

Use of Hong Hua is contraindicated during pregnancy.

Do not exceed the recommended dose of Hong Hua. It may cause incessant bleeding.

Review Questions

- Actions and indications of Hong Hua
- What pair of herbs are commonly used in treating gynecological and post-partum conditions?
- Herbs for treating trauma injury.

Yi Mǔ Cǎo 益母草

“mother’s herb” benefit mother herb”

- Herba Leonuri Heterophylli
- English: Chinese motherwort, leonurus
- Properties: acrid, bitter, slightly cold
- Channels: Heart, Liver, bladder

Actions and Indications

Actions: Invigorates the blood, expels blood stasis, and regulates the menses:

Indications: commonly used for gynecologic disorders such as irregular menstruation, premenstrual abdominal pain, immobile abdominal masses, infertility, and postpartum abdominal pain with lochioschesis

- Yi Mu Cao is one of the best and most commonly used herbs for treating various gynecological disorders caused by blood stagnation. It is essential for regulating blood circulation in the Chong channel.
- In postpartum women with spotting, Yi Mu Cao helps contract the uterus to expel residual stagnation.

Actions: Yi Mu Cao can be used to treat traumatic injury with pain.

Indications:

- Abdominal pain because of irregular menstruation or amenorrhea: Yi Mu Cao, Dan Gui, Bai Shao, Chuan Xiong
- Severe postpartum abdominal pain and uterine bleeding, use Yi Mu Cao as a single herb remedy or in a formula: Pao Jian, Yu Mu Cao, Shan Zha
- Traumatic injury with pain: Hong Hua, Tao Ren, Ru Xiang, Zhi Zi

Actions: Promotes urination and reduces swelling:

Indications: for acute systemic edema. Yi Mu Cao can be used individually.

Actions: Clears heat and eliminates toxins

Indications: For dermatological disorders, including eczema, sores, ulcers, and itching skin. It can be used internally and topically.

Recent studies have shown Yi Mu Cao has antiplatelet and cardiovascular effects, clinically used for treating hypertension or coronary artery disease.

Main Actions:

- Invigorates the blood, eliminates blood stasis and regulates menses.
- Promotes urination and reduces swelling

Dosage: 10-15 grams in decoction, with a maximum of 30 grams. Yi Mu Cao is commonly used internally and topically.

Cautions

Yin deficiency, blood deficiency, yang deficiency with prolapse or during pregnancy.

Review questions

- Actions and indications of Yi Mu Cao
- Herbs as “Yao Yao” for treating gynecological disorders.
- Herbs promotes urination and reduces swelling and edema.
- Herbs for treating coronary heart disease.

Zé Lán 泽兰
“marsh orchid”

- Herba Lycopi Lucidi
- English: lycopus, hirsute shiny bugleweed
- Properties: bitter, acrid, aromatic, slightly warm
- Channels: Liver, Spleen

Actions and Indications

Actions: Invigorates blood and dispels blood stasis

Indications: for gynecologic disorders, including menstrual pain, irregular menses, and postpartum disorders.

- Ze Lan is warm without dryness, dispersing without harshness.
- It is a mild herb that invigorates the blood, dispels blood stasis, and regulates menstruation.
- It is a commonly used herb that treats various gynecological disorders due to qi and blood stagnation.
- Menstrual disorders: Dang Gui, Chuan Xiong, Xiang Fu

Actions: Invigorates the blood and dispels blood stasis:

Indications: used topically or internally for pain and swelling from traumatic injury or abscess: Chuan Xiong, Hong Hua, Tao Ren

Actions: Promotes urination and reduces swelling:

Indications: for post-partum edema, post-partum painful urinary dysfunction and systemic or facial edema

Main Actions:

- Invigorates the blood, dispels blood stasis
- Promotes urination and reduces swelling

Dosage: 10-15 grams in decoction.

Review questions

- Actions and indications of Zhe Lan
- What herbs are commonly used to treat gynecological conditions, promote urination and reduce swelling?

Huái Niú Xī 怀牛膝 “ox (cow’s) knee from Huai”

- Radix Achyranthis Bidentatae
- English: achyranthes root
- Properties: bitter, sour, neutral
- Channels: Liver, Kidney

Chuān Niú Xī 川牛膝 “ox (cow’s) knee from Sichuan”

- Radix Cyathulae

- English: cyathula, medicinal cyathula root
- Properties: bitter, sour, neutral
- Channels: Liver, Kidney

Actions and Indications

Actions: Invigorates the blood and expels blood stasis:

Indications: for blood stasis patterns with such symptoms as dysmenorrhea, amenorrhea, and lochioschesis, and traumatic injury below the waist.

Niú Xī 牛膝

- Gynecological disorders: Hong Hua, Tao Ren, Dang Gui
- Difficult labor: Dang Gui, Chuan Xiong, Gui Ban
- Musculoskeletal pain due to external and sports injuries: Dang Gui, Chuan Xiong, Xu Duan

Actions: Tonifies the Liver and kidney, strengthens the sinews and bones and benefits the joints:

Indications: for pain and soreness of the lower back and knees due to deficiency; Nui Xi tonifies and nourishes the Liver and Kidneys

- Niu Xi tonifies the Liver and Kidney, strengthens the sinews and bones, opens channels and collaterals, thereby benefiting the joints
- Niu Xi is one of the most important and effective herbs for chronic pain in the lower body, such as lumbago or weak knees.
- Sore and achy low back and knees: Du Zhong, Xu Duan, Shan Ji Sheng, Mu Gua
- Severe weakness below the waist due to Liver and Kidney deficiency: Shu Di, Gui Ban, Suo Yang
- Redness, swelling and pain in the lower body joints due to damp-heat: Cang Zhu, Huang Bai, Yi Yi Ren
- Wind-damp Bi syndrome: Mu Gua, Du Huo, Bi Xie, Fang Ji

Actions: Promotes urination, invigorates blood and unblocks Lin syndrome

Indications: for blood in urine, difficult urination or painful urinary dysfunction: Tong Cao, Hua Shi, Che Qian Zi, Qu Mai

Actions: Directs fire and blood downward

Indications: for reckless movement of hot blood in the upper burner or yin deficiency with ascending fire. Bai Mao Gen, Xiao Ji, Zhi Zi, Bai Shao, Sheng Di Huang, Mu Li, Zhi Mu

Main Actions:

- Invigorates blood and dispels blood stasis
- Tonifies the liver and kidney, strengthens the sinews and bones.
- Promotes urination
- Directs fire and blood downward

Dosage: 6-15 grams in decoction.

Cautions: during pregnancy or profuse menstrual bleeding.

Review questions

- Which channels does Niu Xi enter?
- What are the differences between Huai and Chuan Niu Xi?
- Actions and indications of Niu Xi
- What herbs work below the waist?

Wáng Bù Liú Xíng 王不留行 “king who does not stay but departs”

Semen Vaccariae Segetalis

English: vaccaria seeds, cow-soapwort seed

Properties: bitter, neutral

Channels: Liver, Stomach

Actions and Indications

Actions: Invigorates the blood and opens channels:

Indications: In the upper part of the body this herb promotes lactation. In the lower part of the body, it unblocks menstruation.

- Wang Bu Liu Xing has a moving and dispersing action that invigorates blood and opens channels.
- Wang Bu Liu Xing treats menstrual disorders with pain and swelling that are caused by blood stasis and obstruction of the channels: Dang Gui, Xiang Fu, Hong Hua, Chuan Xiong

Actions: Promotes lactation

Indications: for insufficient lactation.

Main Actions:

- Invigorates the blood and opens channels
- Promotes lactation

Dosage: 6-10 grams in decoction.

Cautions

Wang Bu Liu Xing is contraindicated during pregnancy, as it stimulates contraction of the uterus.

Review questions

- What is the character of this herb?
- Actions and indications of Wang Bu Liu Xing
- What herbs promote lactation?

Jī Xuè Téng 鸡血藤 “chicken blood vine”

- Radix et Caulis Spatholobi Jixueteng
- English: spatholobus, millettia root and vine
- Properties: bitter, slightly sweet, warm
- Channels: Liver

Actions and Indications

Actions: Invigorates and tonifies the blood:

Indications: for blood deficiency patterns with symptoms such as dysmenorrhea, irregular menstruation or amenorrhea with abdominal pain: Dang Gui, Chuan Xiong, Shu Di

Actions: Invigorates the blood, opens the channels and collaterals and relaxes the sinews:

Indications: for numbness of extremities, low back pain, knee pain or generalized joint soreness from wind-damp painful obstruction, with either blood deficiency or stasis

Main Actions:

- Invigorates and tonifies the blood
- Opens the channels and collaterals and relaxes the sinews

Dosage: 10 – 15 grams. The maximum dose of Ji Xue Teng is 30 grams.

Ji Xue Teng gao (syrup) is made from a combination of Chuan Niu Xi, Xu Duan, Hong Hua, black beans, and Yi Tang. It is focused on tonifying the blood.

Review questions

- Actions and indications of Ji Xue Teng
- What herbs tonify and move the blood?
- Herbs that invigorate the blood and treats Bi syndrome?

É Zhú 莪术

- Rhizoma Curcumae Ezhu
- English: zedoary rhizome, curcuma zedoaria
- Properties: acrid, bitter, warm
- Channels: Liver, Spleen

Actions and Indications

Actions: Invigorates blood and breaks up blood stasis, promotes the movement of qi, and alleviates pain.

Indications: for abdominal pain, amenorrhea, dysmenorrhea, abdominal masses, and epigastric masses due to blood stasis

- E Zhu strongly breaks up chronic or severe blood stasis. It is usually used when all other blood-invigorating herbs have failed to show satisfactory results.
- Amenorrhea with abdominal pain: San Leng, Chuan Xiong, Niu Xi
- Masses: San Leng, Dan Shen, Bie Jia

Actions: Dissolves accumulations and alleviates pain:

Indications: for pain, distention, fullness and constriction in the chest and abdomen due to food stagnation: San Leng, Mu Xiang, Shan Zha

Main Actions:

- Invigorates blood and breaks up blood stasis
- Promotes the movement of qi and alleviates pain

Dosage: 3-10 grams in decoction. Frying E Zhu with vinegar enhances its pain-relieving effects.

Cautions:

E Zhu is contraindicated in deficiency patients or those with hypermenorrhea.

E Zhu is contraindicated during pregnancy.

Review Questions

- Actions and indications of E Zhu
- What herb breaks up blood stasis and invigorates the blood?
- What herb is used for severe food stagnation?

Sān Léng 三棱
“three edges”

- Rhizoma Sparganii Stoloniferi
- English: sparganium, common bur-reed rhizome
- Properties: bitter, neutral
- Channels: Liver, Spleen

Actions and Indications

Actions: Forcefully breaks up blood stasis, promotes the movement of qi and alleviates pain:

Indications: for blood stasis patterns with amenorrhea, dysmenorrhea, post partum abdominal pain and abdominal masses

Actions: Dissolves accumulations and alleviates pain

Indications: for severe abdominal pain and distention due to food stagnation and stagnant qi

Main Actions:

- Invigorates blood and breaks up blood stasis
- Promotes the movement of qi and alleviates pain

Dosage: 3-10 grams in decoction. Frying San Leng with vinegar enhances its pain-relieving effects.

Caution: Because the dispersing action of these two herbs is quite strong, it can injure the normal qi; therefore, the combination must be used with caution in patients who are weak or deficient, and is contraindicated during pregnancy.

Review Questions

- Actions and indications of San Leng
- There are two herbs that are often combined to break up blood stasis and invigorate the blood.
- What herb is used for severe food stagnation?

Wǔ Líng Zhī 五灵脂
“flying squirrel feces” “fat of the five spirits”

- Excrementum Troglodyti seu Pteromi
- English: pteropus feces, troglodytes dung
- Properties: bitter, sweet, warm
- Channels: Liver

Actions and Indications

Actions: Invigorates blood, dispels blood stasis and alleviates pain:

Indications: for a variety of disorders caused by blood stasis, including amenorrhea, dysmenorrhea, post partum abdominal pain, chest and epigastric pain.

Actions: Transforms stasis and stops bleeding:

Indications: for uterine bleeding and lochioschisis due to or with blood stasis. Use toasted Wu Ling Zhi, plus-San Qi, Sheng Di, Mu Dan Pi

Main Actions

- Invigorates blood, dispels blood stasis and alleviates pain
- Dispels blood stasis and stops bleeding

Dosage: 3-10 grams in decoction. Wu Ling Zhi should be wrapped in cheesecloth prior to cooking in decoction.

Cautions:

During pregnancy or with blood deficient patients
Antagonizes Ren Shen

Review questions

- Actions and indications of Wu Ling Zhi
- Herb invigorate blood and stop bleeding?
- What special preparation is required when putting Wu Ling Zhi in a decoction?

Hǔ Zhàng 虎杖
“tiger’s cane”

- Radix et Rhizoma Polygoni Cuspidati
- English: polygonum cuspidatum
- Properties: bitter, cold
- Channels: Liver, Gallbladder, Lung

Actions and Indications

Actions: Invigorates the blood, dispels stasis, unblocks the channels and alleviates pain:

Indications: for amenorrhea, wind-damp painful obstruction and traumatic injury

Actions: Clears heat and resolves dampness:

Indications: for damp-heat jaundice and turbid vaginal discharge: Yin Chen Hao, Jin Qian Cao

Actions: Clears heat and eliminates toxins

Indications: for burns, carbuncles and other skin infections and snakebite: Hu Zhang can be used internally and externally.

Actions: Drains heat downward, transforms phlegm and stops cough:

Indications: for cough due to Lung heat: Huang Qin, Shi Gao, Jin Yin Hua

Main Actions:

- Invigorates the blood, eliminates blood stasis, opens the channels and alleviates pain.
- Clears damp-heat
- Clears heat and eliminates toxins
- Drains heat from the Lung, transforms phlegm and stops cough

Dosage: 10-30 grams in decoction. Hu Zhang is used both internally and topically.

Review questions:

- Actions and indications of Hu Zhang.
- Herbs in this section that treating Bi syndrome or trauma injury.
- Herbs for treating jaundice.
- Herbs that can be used internal and external for skin burn or skin lesion due to heat toxins.
- Herbs for treating Lung heat leading cough